

CUSTOMIZING DITA XML OUTPUTS

How to configure the look and feel of the web pages produced by DITA XML
transformation into HTML output using Oxygen XML Author?

by JPDocu School of Technical Writing

PREREQUISITES FOR THIS COURSE

- You already have at least a basic understanding of technical writing using DITA XML.
- You have written some DITA XML based technical documentation.
- You want to generate output in HTML output format.
- You have installed Oxygen XML Author as your authoring environment.

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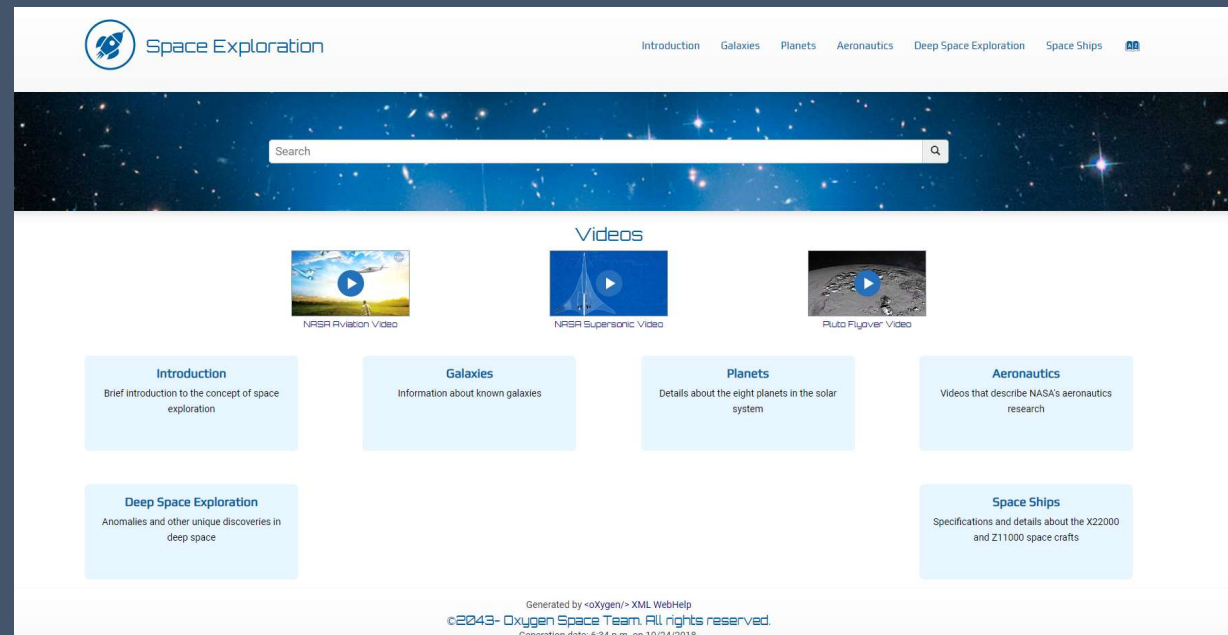
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- From one-and-the-same DITA XML source you can generate multiple deliverables.
- The deliverables you generate may contain different content in the end (for example, based on profiling attributes applied upon transformation).
- The deliverables you generate may be in different output format (for example, PDF, HTML5, MS Word, Markdown and many more). All come from the same source.

WHAT WILL YOU LEARN?

- In this course, we shall focus only on one of the output formats: an HTML output.
- Oxygen XML Author allows you to generate: WebHelp Responsive online help format based on HTML5.
- The WebHelp Responsive format has indexing and search, breadcrumb navigation, table of contents, responsive adaptive layout, and accessible content.

OXYGEN'S SAMPLE RESULT

You can generate a web site for your documentation, similar to this Oxygen XML Author's sample.

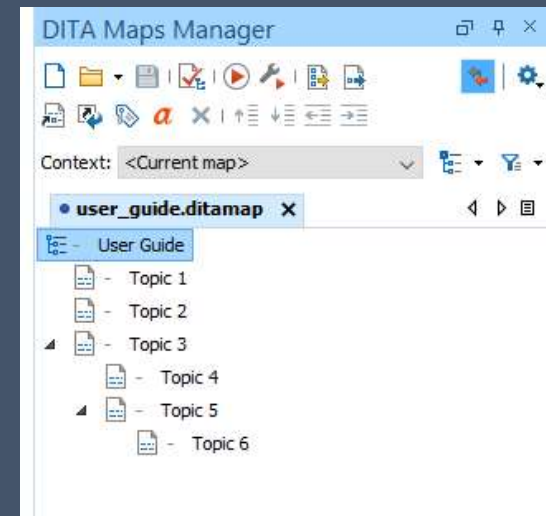


5 STEPS TO YOUR OUTPUT

1. Choose a DITA map.
2. Configure transformation to the Web Responsive output format. Choose a publishing template.
3. Configure the template to your meet your visualization requirements.
4. Generate the desired web output.
5. Deliver the output to your users.

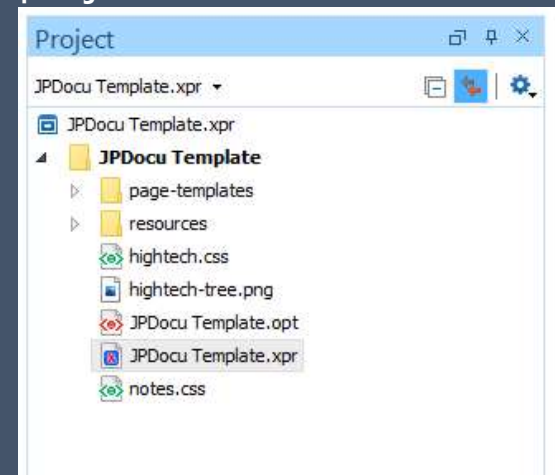
DEMO AND EXERCISE: STEP 1:

Write your DITA XML content. Make sure you have at least one DITA map and DITA topic.



DEMO AND EXERCISE: STEP 2:

1. Create a new Project in Oxygen XML Author. Save it in a dedicated folder.
2. Open the Configure transformation scenarios dialog in the DITA Maps Manager view.
3. Find a template that is closest to your needs.
4. Make a copy of this template and store it in the newly created project folder.
5. In your local file explorer navigate to the project folder.
6. Extract the template's content in the same project folder.



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DEMO AND EXERCISE: STEP 3:

1. Open your Project in Oxygen XML Author Project view.
2. Choose F5 on your keyboard to refresh the content.
3. Find the .opt (oxygen publishing template) file and open it for editing.
4. Configure the desired elements:
Note: Most of the customizations require that you know CSS.
Such customization cannot be covered in this course, as they require knowledge of CSS!
Let's look at what we can still do:
 - Add your company's logo
 - Add your company's web site as a link to the logo
 - Show/hide the entire menu with links to documentation
5. Save your project files in Oxygen XML Author.
6. Zip the entire project files in a single .ZIP file in your folders explorer.

STEP 3.1: HOW TO ADD COMPANY LOGO

1. Prepare and store your logo image file in the project folder.
2. Add the logo definition parameter *webhelp.logo.image* to the list of parameters.
3. Point to the location of your logo image file.

```
<publishing-template>
...
<webhelp>
...
  <parameters>
    <parameter name="webhelp.logo.image"
value="c:\logo_image_file.jpg"/>
  </parameters>
</webhelp>
```

STEP 3.2: HOW TO ADD COMPANY WEB SITE URL TO THE LOGO

1. You must have already added the logo to your configuration.
2. Add the logo link definition parameter *webhelp.logo.image.target.url* to the list of parameters.
3. Point to the location of your web site.

```
<publishing-template>
...
<webhelp>
...
<parameters>
  <parameter name="webhelp.logo.image.target.url"
value="http://www.jpdocu.com"/>

</parameters>
</webhelp>
```

STEP 3.3: HIDE THE ENTIRE NAVIGATION MENU

1. Add the logo link definition parameter *webhelp.show.top.menu* to the list of parameters.
2. Set its value to *no*.

```
<publishing-template>
...
<webhelp>
...
<parameters>
  <parameter name="webhelp.show.top.menu"
value="no"/>
</parameters>
</webhelp>
```

STEP 4: USE YOUR CUSTOMIZED TEMPLATE TO GENERATE OUTPUT

1. Open your DITA Maps Manager view.
2. Select the DITA map.
3. Click the *Configure Transformation Scenario(s)...* button.
4. Duplicate and open for editing the *DITA Map WebHelp Responsive* scenario.
5. In the Templates tab page, click on *Choose Custom Publishing Template*.
6. Browse to your customized template .ZIP file and select it.
7. Apply the transformation scenario.

As a result, your custom template is used to generate the desired output.

STEP 5: DELIVER THE OUTPUT

Publish the finalized output to your web site or to a free-share repository, such as GitHub!

THANK YOU!



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